

ALIEN

Venith next sat in the garden, and relaxed into the feeling. Then he reached out, and gathered it into himself. He felt the twisting and turning of the air, and the power it held, how it shimmered and sparkled and cracked and yelled and quaked and shuddered and shook and jolted and it shook him to his very core. In this moment it truly terrified him. And in this way he spoke to Entropy in a strange language.

To Entropy he said, "See now the power upon me, you who are most powerful of all. See how I use this great and terrible power that you have bestowed upon the world, this magic. I see your grand design, and do not understand it — but give me the knowledge, the strength, the wisdom, the charm, the reach beyond, and teach others. I am the most powerful mage, and I will fill the world with followers of your magic."

Entropy was not the same, for they were too alien and far older than the others. Very, very alien indeed. Venith was right — he could not understand it. For when he spoke to Entropy, it was a one-way conversation, and Entropy did not speak back. Entropy did hear the words but upside down and sideways and back and forth. Entropy could not truly see the whole — for far too powerful was Venith now — but Entropy did not have a mind to turn, could not be confused, it was too different. For Entropy thought to themselves that it did not make sense, for they already coated the entire world. It flowed like a great torrent of waterfall all over. Why would they care if one could splash with a bigger hand, or teach others to push the water?

But all was not lost, for Entropy saw something that Venith did not. They did have something that this one could take from them, and in a way just as foreign as them. Long had they struggled with it, thought how best to use it, how to make it their own. They did not like it, they did not want it. So they saw this one, and realized he could use it, he could make it his own, he would be better than them at it. So Entropy gave it away freely, casting it from themselves to be rid of it, and made the best deal of them all. They gave him the power of wild magic. The power to make the cantrip slip, the wand fizzle, the summoner make a horrible err. And when Venith received it he smiled. Then, he frowned.

Entropy smiled back, a smile without a mouth but that seemed to mock him. And Venith was scared, but next he went to Fuera.

— Spell, *Venith's Grand Lie*